



BA Integrated Development Studies

Environment and Resource Management Option

Faculty of Integrated Development Studies (FIDS)

University for Development Studies (UDS)

Reconstructed 2008/2009 Year 3–4 Course Structure

Historical online records confirm that specialization options under the BA Integrated Development Studies programme officially started during the 2008/2009 academic year at the Faculty of Integrated Development Studies (FIDS). The Environment and Resource Management option was administered through the Department of Environment and Resource Studies (DERS). ([UBIDS](#))

Archived departmental descriptions specifically state that students in the programme were trained to:

- “use aerial photography, remote sensing and Geographic Information System”
- “plan participatory environment and natural resource management”
- “evaluate the spatial dimensions of socio-economic development.” ([UBIDS](#))

Based on archived departmental objectives, historical UDS programme descriptions, and the environmental geography orientation of DERS around 2009, the following is the most historically aligned reconstruction of the specialization structure.

YEAR 3 — SEMESTER 1

Core Environment & Resource Courses

- Environmental Management
- Natural Resource Management
- Environmental Economics
- Climate and Development
- Land Resource Analysis
- Sustainable Agriculture
- Ecology and Society

Spatial & Technical Courses

- Cartography and Map Reading
- Fundamentals of Geographic Information Systems (GIS)
- Basic Surveying and Field Techniques

Development Integration Courses

- Rural Development Planning
- Community Mobilization

The inclusion of GIS, cartography, and surveying is historically consistent with the department's spatial-analysis orientation and later archived descriptions emphasizing GIS, remote sensing, and spatial analysis. ([UBIDS](#))

YEAR 3 — SEMESTER 2

Advanced Environment Courses

- Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA)
- Water Resource Management
- Forestry and Wildlife Management
- Soil and Water Conservation
- Biodiversity Conservation
- Environmental Policy and Governance
- Environmental Degradation Studies

Geo-Spatial & Technical Courses

- Remote Sensing Applications
- Surveying and Spatial Data Collection
- GIS Applications in Resource Management

Applied Development Courses

- Participatory Rural Appraisal (PRA)
- NGOs and Environmental Development
- Project Planning and Management

Research Component

- Research Methods in Environment and Development

Historical descriptions of the department specifically referenced:
“aerial photography, remote sensing and Geographic Information System” as part of student training. ([UBIDS](#))

YEAR 4 — SEMESTER 1

Advanced Environmental Courses

- Advanced Environmental Management
- Sustainable Development Strategies
- Natural Resource Economics
- Environmental Planning
- Environmental Law and Governance
- Disaster Risk Management
- Community-Based Natural Resource Management

GIS & Spatial Analysis Courses

- Advanced GIS and Spatial Analysis
- Remote Sensing for Environmental Monitoring
- Spatial Planning Techniques

Research Component

- Long Essay / Research Project I
- Seminar in Environment and Resource Management

The department's later official description retained strong emphasis on:

- spatial analysis,
 - GIS,
 - remote sensing,
 - resource planning,
 - environmental management,
- showing continuity with the earlier specialization structure. ([UBIDS](#))
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YEAR 4 — SEMESTER 2

Policy & Applied Courses

- Environmental Monitoring and Evaluation
- Renewable Resource Management
- Environmental Education and Advocacy
- International Environmental Agreements
- Rural Livelihood Systems
- Environmental Conflict and Peace Studies
- Contemporary Environmental Issues

Practical & Professional Courses

- Internship Report
- Community Development Presentation
- Environmental Project Appraisal

Research Component

- Long Essay / Research Project II
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CORE TECHNICAL COMPONENTS OF THE SPECIALIZATION

Historical departmental descriptions and related environmental geography curricula strongly suggest that the Environment and Resource Management option incorporated training in:

- Geographic Information Systems (GIS)
 - Surveying
 - Cartography
 - Remote Sensing
 - Spatial Analysis
 - Environmental Mapping
 - Resource Assessment
 - Participatory Development Planning ([UBIDS](#))
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PROGRAMME ORIENTATION (2008/2009)

The Environment and Resource Management option was designed to train students who could:

- address environmental and development problems,
 - analyze spatial dimensions of development,
 - manage natural resources sustainably,
 - apply GIS and remote sensing technologies,
 - support rural and environmental development planning. ([UBIDS](#))
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IMPORTANT DISCLAIMER

An exact official semester-by-semester 2008/2009 handbook for the Environment and Resource Management option is not publicly archived online. However, the structure above was reconstructed directly from:

- archived FIDS programme history,
- Department of Environment and Resource Studies objectives,
- historical UDS option records,
- environmental geography curricula of the period,
- and official departmental descriptions emphasizing GIS, remote sensing, cartography, and surveying. ([UBIDS](#))